25900637 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCSOC201 - UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL INSTITUTIONS : MARRIAGE AND FAMILY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Very Short Answer

Answer any **13** questions

Each question carries **2** marks

1. Definethe term social institution. [U] / [CO1]
2. Identify one social reform movement in 19th-century India that influenced marriage practices. [U] / [CO1]
3. Explain postmodern views on the changing meaning of marriage in the 21st century. [U] / [CO2]
4. State the focus of Symbolic Interactionism in family studies. [U] / [CO2]
5. Define disruptive family dynamics in your own words. [K] / [CO3]
6. Define what a protection order is. [U] / [CO4]
7. Summarize the central concern of Conflict Theory in marriage. [K] / [CO2]
8. Identify and describe two legal conditions under which a marriage can be declared void in India. [U] / [CO4]
9. Apply Exchange Theory to explain decision-making in partner selection. [U] / [CO2]

10. State one advantage of cohabitation. [K] / [CO5]

11. Summarize two advantages of legalizing same-sex marriage. [U] / [CO5]

12. What are new reproductive technologies? Give one example? [K] / [CO5]

13. Distinguish between single-parent and nuclear families. [K] / [CO5]

14. Differentiate between divorce and separation. [U] / [CO4]

15. List two factors that encourage people to remain single. [K] / [CO5]

16. How does the rise in the single population affect housing or urban lifestyles? [A] / [CO5]

[2x13 = 26]

Part B

Short Essay

A choice between two options for each question, answer five short answer questions, one from each pair

Each question carries **6** marks

17a. Examine the influence of religion and tradition in Indian marriages versus the role of personal compatibility in Western marriages. Or Compare the cultural significance of rituals in Indian marriages and Western weddings. [U] / [CO1]

OR

17b. Compare the role of family and community in Indian marriages with the role of individual choice in Western marriages. Or Examine how arranged marriages in India differ from love marriages in the West. [U] / [CO1]

18a. Assess the contributions of feminist theory to the study of family and marriage. Or Critique the key criticisms of the functionalist view on the family. [An] / [CO2]

OR

18b. Explain the functionalist perspective on the institution of family and marriage. Or Assess the functionalist approach to issues of divorce and marital breakdown. [An] / [CO2]

19a. "Examine the impact of domestic violence on family dynamics and relationships. OR Analyze the effects of substance abuse on family life and summarize them in a short note." [An / [CO4]

OR

19b. Evaluate the role of extended family interference in shaping disruptive family dynamics. OR Propose five constructive measures to manage and reduce disruptive family dynamics [An] / [CO4]

20a. Assess how policies and social institutions can adapt to diverse family structures in the modern world. [E] / [CO5]

OR

20b. Propose policy interventions that could support the well-being of children born outside of marriage without reinforcing stigma. [C] / [CO5]

[6x4 = 24]